

10.3 Testing The Site

Once your site is uploaded, you can navigate to it and start going through it to make sure everything is OK. The reason you have to check your site is that very often, when transferring the site from your local machine to a Web server, links get skewed. You might have uploaded a few files into the wrong folder, or a few files might not have uploaded properly (or at all). If you built your own HTML site with a Web page editor, especially a site that has over 40 pages, you might have missed a link or two which point to something on your local hard drive instead of a relative link to a folder. This means that you have a few images or links on your site that point to something like “C:\Documents and Settings\Administrator\My Documents\My Webs\Site\abc.html” instead of just “/abc.html”. As a result, it’s obvious that you’re going to get a “404 Page Not Found” error when you click on that link. This is why you need to check each and every link, image and page for errors.

However, if you have a site that’s close to a hundred pages, or runs on a CMS, chances are you’ll be too bored to check all those hundreds of pages, or will end up wasting too much bandwidth. It’s just simpler to let a robot do all the work for you! Head over to www.dead-links.com and type in the URL of your site. Now click “Launch the spider,” sit back, and wait for it to finish its job. The site’s tool has a timeout of 45 minutes, but your site will probably be checked way before that. If it’s not done by then, you have built a site that’s large enough to be a portal, and you should seriously consider paying for some of the more professional site-checking tools!

10.3.1 Standards

In order to check and make sure that your site conforms to most common Web standards, you should visit <http://uitest.com> and enter your site’s URL. You will get a multitude of options and tests, including one which will show you how the Google spider views your site and how it will show up as a Google search result.